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Programme Code: Bachelor of Computer Science

Course Code: BCS-062

Course Title : E- Commerce

Assignment Number : BCA(VI) /062/ Assignment 2025-2026

Study Center Code: 07162P merit

Submission Date: 30/04/2026 Signature: Himanshu

Course Code	:	BCS-062
Course Title	:	E-Commerce
Assignment Number	:	BCA(VI)062/Assignment/2025-26
Maximum Marks	:	100
Weightage	:	25 %
Last Date of Submission	:	31st October, 2025 (For July, Session) 30th April, 2026 (For January, Session)

There are four questions in this assignment. Each question carries 20 marks. Rest 20 marks are for viva-voce. Answer all the questions. You may use illustrations and diagrams to enhance the explanations. Please go through the guidelines regarding assignments given in the Programme Guide for the format of presentation.

Q1:

Compare the strategic implications of adopting mCommerce versus eCommerce for a retail business entering tier-2 and rural markets in India. Focus your answer on customer behavior, technological infrastructure, mobile penetration, payment mechanisms, and localization strategies.

(20 Marks)

Q 2:

Analyze the economic and operational impact of replacing traditional B2B transactions with EDI-based systems in a supply chain. Go beyond the functional aspects of EDI and examine its influence on business agility, cost efficiency, workforce roles, and inter-organizational collaboration.

(20 Marks)

Q3:

Discuss how user behavior, regulatory requirements, and technology adoption have transformed online trading systems, and suggest whether traditional stock brokerage firms still have a viable future.

(20 Marks)

Q4:

Design a comprehensive checklist for evaluating the trustworthiness of an online auction website. *Base* your checklist on principles of consumer protection, transaction integrity, and dispute resolution mechanisms. Also, suggest improvements over existing global auction sites.

(20 Marks)

Q.1 = compare the strategic implications of adopting mcommerce versus ecommerce for a retail business entering tier-2 and rural market in India. focus your answer on customer behaviour technological infrastructure mobile penetration payment mechanism and localization strategies.

Solution

India's retail sector is rapidly transforming, driven by affordable smartphones, inexpensive data, government digital initiatives and growing consumer aspirations beyond metro cities. Tier-2 cities and rural areas are emerging as vital growth market due to rising internet penetrations and an increasing willingness to shop online. For a retail business entering these markets choosing between mobile commerce and traditional web-based e-commerce is a strategic imperative affecting customer interaction infrastructure needs payment methods, and localization approaches. understanding the differences b/w mcommerce and ecommerce is a crucial to tailor effective strategies aligned with the realities of India's non-metro consumers.

Strategic implications of mcommerce versus ecommerce entry in Tier-2 and Rural India.

- 1> Customer Behaviour $\Rightarrow$ consumers in these regions show an increasing preference for online shopping driven by convenience and variety. The rise of "small town elites" reflect growing brand aspiration. Most users access internet primarily via smartphones, shaping shopping habits toward mobile-first experiences.
- 2> Technological Infrastructure $\Rightarrow$ India's vast mobile network infrastructure covers 76.6% of the population with Rural users fueling growth. Government programs like BharatNet have extended 4G and 5G connectivity narrowing the digital divide. However, rural areas still face intermittent power and connectivity issues.
- 3> Mobile Penetration $\Rightarrow$ Rural and tier-2 markets are predominately mobile first with over 1.4 billion cellular connection nationally and projection estimating 504 million Rural internet users by 2025.
- 4> Payment mechanism: Although cash remain widely used digital payment via UPI

Mobile wallets and Aadhaar based System are gaining ground. effective models blend cash-on-delivery with BMS payment and local micro-finance solution to serve both digitally savvy and last mile customers.

- 5) localization strategies $\Rightarrow$ Regional language preference dominates rural internet usage making vernacular content essential. Retailers need to customize product listings, festivals, and promotions to local cultures with mcommerce offering precise hyperlocal targeting through app notifications whatsapp and local influencers.

comparative overview

Factor	mcommerce	ecommerce
customer Behaviour	Mobile first, App-based, impulse and Social driven	web based detailed Browsing
Infrastructure	optimized for Patchy network SMS/Voice	data intensive, reliant on stable broadband
Mobile Penetration	Leverages smartphone & feature phone growth	Limited by desktop/laptop.

Strategic Recommendations

- Prioritize mcommerce $\Rightarrow$ Develop mobile apps, Progressive web app, and voice/BMS platform to harness the high mobile user base.
- Invest in localization $\Rightarrow$ Build Regional language interfaces local community engagement and culturally relevant content.
- Adopt hybrid commerce $\Rightarrow$ combine mcommerce and ecommerce with omnichannel touchpoint including physical outlets and social platforms.
- ensure payment flexibility $\Rightarrow$ integrate cash-on delivery with innovative digital payment method to bridge trust and infrastructure gaps.

Q.2 Analyze the economic and operational impact of replacing traditional B2B transaction with EDI based system in supply chain. Go beyond the functional aspects of EDI and examine its influence on business agility, cost efficiency, workforce roles and inter-organizational collaboration.

Solution

Introduction electronic data interchange has revolutionized supply chains by replacing traditional paper based B2B

transactions with seamless, standardized electronic communications. Beyond simply automating document exchanges, EDI fundamentally enhances business agility, reduces costs, transform workforce and strengthens collaboration between supply chain partners.

1> Business Agility

- **Faster response Times:** EDI enables near real-time sharing of critical information such as inventory updates, order confirmations, and demand forecasts. This rapid data flow allows organizations to react promptly to market shifts and supply chain disruptions.
- **enhances Market flexibility** → Automated data exchange simplifies onboarding new trading partners and adjusting procurement or distribution processes quickly.
- **operational Scalability** → Standardized EDI workflows reduce the complexity of integrating new suppliers or entering new regions, allowing businesses to expand with minimal operational disruption.

2> cost efficiency

- Reduce Transaction costs $\Rightarrow$ By eliminating manual paper handling EDI cuts transaction-related expenses significantly often up to 35% for high-volume business.
- error minimization $\Rightarrow$ Automated, consistent data format reduce human error common in manual entries thereby lowering financial losses from order discrepancies.
- Labor savings $\Rightarrow$ Automation decreases dependence on clerical staff to routine tasks translating into payroll cost saving and freeing employees to engage in strategic activities.

3> Workforce Roles

- Evolving Responsibilities $\Rightarrow$ With EDI automating routine exchanges workforce role shift toward managing EDI system, handling exception and overseeing partner relationship rather than routine manual processing.
- Skill enhancement $\Rightarrow$ employees need advanced skill in ~~advanced~~ EDI Technology troubleshooting, Data Analysis, and Supply chain intelligence interpretation to support digital operations.

- Reduced manual labour $\rightarrow$ Less clerical work allows Personnel to focus more on continuous process improvement and strategic collaboration.

4) ~~Internal~~ Inter-organizational collaboration

- Strengthened Partnerships $\rightarrow$ Timely, Accurate, and Secure data sharing via EDI fosters trust and Reliability among supply chain members improving synchronization of production and delivery schedules.
- Standardized communication $\rightarrow$ uniform data format eliminate misunderstanding and improve interoperability, facilitating smoother transaction between diverse partners.
- Enhanced Visibility $\rightarrow$ EDI enhances end-to-end supply chain transparency enable better tracking inventory optimization and reduction of stockouts.

Q.3 = Discuss How user behaviour regulatory requirement and technology Adoption have transformed online trading system and suggest whether traditional stock brokerage firm still have a viable future.

Col ⇒ The capital market landscape has undergone a profound transformation over the past two decades driven by a complex interplay between evolving user behaviour, stringent regulatory framework and rapid advancement in technology. These dynamics have decisively reshaped the online trading system, transitioning them from traditional broker-assisted model to sophisticated, automated platform that empowers investors to execute trades independently and efficiently.

Transformation of online trading system

(1) Shifts in user behaviour

One of the most significant drivers of change in online trading system is the shift in customer behaviour. The traditional model where investors relied heavily on personalized broker advice and manual intervention has given way to a democratized self-directed trading culture. This evolution is particularly pronounced with the increasing penetration of the internet and mobile devices, widening market access far beyond urban affluent investors to include young professionals.

Access to Real time Data, educational Resources, and advanced Analytics tool on trading Platforms has ~~empe~~ empowered users to (take control) of their investment decisions without intermediary reliance. Social media Platforms, online forums and Investment blogs also play a critical Role in shaping behaviour by fostering communities for knowledge exchange and crowd-sourced investment strategies.

(v) Impact of Regulatory Requirement

The dramatic rise of internet-based trading has led Regulatory authorities worldwide to strengthen oversight and enforce rigorous compliance standards to protect investors and ensure market integrity. Agencies like SEBI in India have responded with enhanced Regulatory framework mandating stricter risk management

The introduction of T+1 settlements cycle and legislation such as a digital Operational Resilience Act highlight the growing emphasis on real time data exchange seamless technology integration and cybersecurity resilience. These regulations ensure that market operations remain transparent secure and efficient while fostering investor confidence in a digital trading ecosystem.

(3) Technology Adoption and Innovation

Technological innovation has been a catalyst in the transformation of online trading. The ubiquity of high speed internet coupled with mobile penetration has made trading platforms accessible anytime and anywhere.

More advanced technologies such as Artificial Intelligence, machine learning, big data analytics, and block-chain have revolutionized how trading is executed and managed. Algorithmic and high frequency trading allow for rapid, precise trade execution which reduces latency and slippage.

Future of Traditional Stock Brokerage firms

Despite the sweeping shift toward self-directed online trading, traditional stock brokerage firms continue to hold a viable and important role within the capital markets ecosystem.

Traditional brokers are expanding into wealth management, insurance, estate planning and retirement advisory services - areas that require personalized human expertise and relationships management.

Moreover, the Regulatory emphasis on generating Advisory from Execution has reinforced the need for broker who provide comprehensive Portfolio management risk mitigation and legally compliant Stewardships of client assets.

Q.4

Solution

(1) Consumer Protocol Principles

- clear and Transparent Policies $\Rightarrow$ The website must feature Accessible, well structured term of service, Privacy Policies and user agreements. These document should mainly define the Rights.
- Strong user verification $\Rightarrow$ To mitigate the risk of fraud and Phantom Account the Platform should implement rigorous identify verification practices including multi-factor authentication and "Know Your Customer" (KYC) checks.
- Data Privacy and Security compliance $\Rightarrow$ compliance with global data privacy regulations like GDPR and CCPA is essential. The site should use robust encryption, standards.

- Fair and transparent auction practices $\Rightarrow$ The bidding process should be open and unbiased featuring real time updates and notifications.

(2) Transaction Integrity

- Secure Payment Gateways $\Rightarrow$ Integration with trusted payment providers offering multiple payment method is critical.
- Escrow services for payment protection $\Rightarrow$ escrow mechanisms where funds are held secure until a buyer confirms product receipts and satisfaction. Reduce risks related to fraud.
- Comprehensive Product Description $\Rightarrow$ Seller must provide detailed information about items, including high-quality images specification and status of the goods.
- Seller verification and Rating system $\Rightarrow$ A reliable seller evaluation system based on past transaction history, buyer feedback, and dispute records helps buyer choose trustworthy seller and disciplines seller behaviour.

(3) Dispute resolution mechanisms

- Responsive customer support $\Rightarrow$ The platform should offer 24/7 multichannel support staffed by knowledgeable personnel able to resolve.

- formal and fair dispute handling $\Rightarrow$ established, time-bound procedures for complaint registration, investigation and resolution prefer by with impartial third party arbitration or mediation ensure.
- clear Refund and Return Policies $\Rightarrow$ Transparent and equitable refund return and cancellation terms balance the protection of buyer and seller rights fostering trust in the transactional process.

Suggested improvements over existing global auction sites

- AI-Powered fraud detection $\Rightarrow$ Implement advanced machine learning algorithms that detect anomalies such as suspicious bidding pattern, fake profiles and misrepresented product faster.
- Blockchain integration for transparency $\Rightarrow$ using blockchain to immutably record bids transaction history, and delivery proofs increases transparency and reduces disputes related to manipulation or false claims.
- Localized consumer protections $\Rightarrow$ Tailoring policies, dispute mechanisms and support services to align with regional legal frameworks.
- Social Proof and community engagement feature $\Rightarrow$ integrate verified user testimonials social media connections and community forum to foster active engagement.